

County Council Meeting - November 18th, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NE4mFFDHSyQ
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Body: Delaware County Council

Meeting Date: November 18, 2025

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Public Hearing on the Muny Recovery Lease Agreement [00:00:04](#).
- **Summary of Discussion:** The presiding officer opened the public hearing to receive comments on the proposed lease agreement involving Muny Recovery (noted as doing business as Indiana Treatment Centers). Resident Rick Yenser spoke in favor of the agreement, stating it is a positive fit for Delaware County given recent pullbacks by local mental health providers and noting that the for-profit arrangement generates property tax revenue, unlike local non-profits. He also urged careful use of opioid settlement funds. Hearing no further comments, a motion was made and seconded to close the public hearing, which was approved via roll call vote.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular session of the Delaware County Council was called to order by the presiding officer on November 18, 2025, at approximately 9:10 a.m. [00:02:55](#).
 - **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Flanken, Mr. Hughes, Mr. Mole (President Polk), Mr. Bookout, Mr. Piper, Mr. Gance, Mr. Swannhead (listed variously in roll calls as Council members/officers including Jessica, Dan, Bill, etc.).
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Polk [01:00:07](#).
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - Observed a moment of respect and silence in memory of Corporal Reynolds [00:03:04](#).
 - Recited the Pledge of Allegiance led by Jack [00:03:31](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - Removed September meeting minutes from the table and approved the September 23, 2025 minutes [00:04:44](#).
 - Approved the October 28, 2025 council meeting minutes [00:05:41](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Elected Officials & Department Head Updates [00:06:07](#)

- **Presenter:** Jeff Stanley (Sheriff's Office), Gavin Green (Coroner), and Steven Brand (Commissioners' Office).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Jeff Stanley expressed gratitude for community support following the tragic passing of Corporal Reynolds and detailed upcoming public viewing and funeral arrangements.
 - Gavin Green reported 613 coroner calls for the year to date and noted that hospital referrals have begun to decrease.
 - Steven Brand reminded attendees regarding employee open enrollment and clarified a recent commissioner adjustment updating benefit billing and payroll deductions from 26 pays to 24 pays to align with vendor billings.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational updates only; no formal board action required.
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Financial Transfers

- **00:10:43 County General (Jail):** Transfer of \$4,700 from Correctional Officer line to Part-Time line (Net transfer: \$0).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff / Elizabeth.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:11:38 Public Defender:** Transfer of \$3,084 (\$1,158 and \$1,926) from Public Defender salary lines to Health Insurance line (Net transfer: \$0).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:12:45 Courts:** Transfer of \$1,676 from Contractual Services to Equipment for security camera upgrades at Juvenile Court.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:13:54 Coroner:** Transfer of \$15,000 from Contractual Services (Autopsies) to Operating Supplies for end-of-year supplies, including shelving, body bags, conference room chairs, and commercial-size flags for EMS/ambulances.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Gavin Green, Coroner.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:16:04 Adult User Fee:** Transfer involving probation officer salary adjustment (\$574), health insurance (\$3,280 credit), disability insurance (\$6), and professional services (\$2,700 for grant-funded kiosk invoices) (Net transfer: \$0).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Probation Department.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:19:01 Public Defender Supplemental:** Transfer of \$51.33 from Other Supplies and \$266.33 from Postage to Rental/Lease Building (\$215 increase) to cover storage unit rate hikes.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey, Public Defender's Office.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).

Appropriations

- **00:28:27 Pre-Trial Diversion (Outside County General):** Appropriation of \$34,244 for part-time staffing and associated FICA, health insurance, and workers' compensation.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lisa Carr, Prosecutor's Office.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:30:58 Public Defender Supplemental:** Appropriation of \$25,666 for Health Insurance.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:33:55 Backfilling Report:**
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to receive backfill report approved by roll call vote.

- **00:31:38 Jury Fee:** Appropriation of \$10,000 for Other Services and Charges to cover increased jury trial volume.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
 - **00:32:52 Reassessment:** Appropriation of \$3,928 for FICA, PERF, health insurance, and life insurance.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanim) **00:33:16** (Approved by Roll Call Vote).
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Ordinances & Resolutions

- **00:34:30 Ordinance 2025-26: Salary Ordinance Administration**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An ordinance fixing schedules of compensation and positions for elected officials, appointed positions, and employees for calendar year 2026, incorporating open-gov compensation data as an exhibit.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Entered for First Reading and approved by roll call vote **00:37:52**.
 - **00:38:06 Ordinance 2025-25: Hiring and Salary Procedures (Second Reading)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Matt Whitehead / HR.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Defined terms and established procedures for hiring and salaries (excluding merit officers). Discussion centered on amending Section 9 (part-time pay rate classification ranging from \$12 to \$20/hour) while ensuring Section 7 (backfilling procedures) remained unchanged from prior standing practice rather than introducing new committee review delays.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Amended and adopted via roll call vote focusing strictly on Section 9 updates **00:45:22**.
 - **00:45:39 Resolution 2025-25: Lease for Real Property (Muny Recovery Agreement)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Council / Commissioners / Commissioner Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Approving a triple net lease agreement for real property pursuant to Indiana Code 36-1-11-C3C2 with Muny Recovery (for-profit entity operating Indiana Treatment Centers). Board discussed triple net lease terms, tenant maintenance responsibilities, property tax generation, liability waivers, and county protections.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote **00:51:07**.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:11:50 Rick Yenser (Newsman and Author):** Commented on local tax revelations presented by Purdue economist Larry DeBoer regarding recent state tax legislation, property assessment increases impacting residents, the high concentration of tax-exempt non-profit and institutional properties (hospital and university) downtown, and concerns over government spending on housing developments.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Matt Whitehead gave an update on the Job Description and Compensation Committee, Google Workspace cloud migration trials, and HR process reviews.
 - Amber Green, President of the Delaware County Redevelopment Commission, provided a quarterly update detailing drainage projects in Yorktown, county highway paving assistance, the Make My Move program expansion, and TIFF revenue agreements.
 - Treasurer Brad Polk provided an update on exploring a municipal line of credit with local banks (Star Financial Bank and First Merchants Bank), noting application fees and terms, which the council opted to review informationally without executing immediate borrowing.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded with holiday wishes and reminders regarding public safety personnel working through Thanksgiving, followed by a motion to adjourn approved by roll call vote **01:15:12**.
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